

CANDACE TARIRO HUNZWI

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EDUCATION

ASHESI UNIVERSITY Accra, Ghana

Expected June 2025

Bachelor's Computer Science

Mastercard Foundation Scholar Program Recipient, Dean's List 2022-2023, 2024/2025

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Machine Learning, Object-Oriented Programming, Algorithm Design and Analysis, Artificial Intelligence, Discrete Structures & Theory, Software Engineering, Web Technologies, Operating Systems, Networks and Data Communication, Cloud Computing, Mobile Application Development, Data Science

WORK EXPERIENCE

HP TECH VENTURES

Corporate Venture Capital & Business Analytics Remote Extern

Dec 2023 - Feb 2024

- Processed and analyzed 20+ large datasets using OpenRefine, Excel, and SQL, identifying trends that influenced investment strategies and startup evaluations.
- Developed interactive market maps and visualizations that streamlined decision-making, leading to the recommendation of 5 high-potential startups for due diligence.
- Conducted in-depth research on startup metrics, industry trends, and business models, uncovering competitive advantages that informed investment decisions.

PRINCETON UNIVERSITY

Research Software Engineer Fellow

June 2023 - Sept 2023

- Enhanced Nasdaq TotalView-ITCH.jl by implementing support for version 5.0, adding logic for new message types and formats, and ensuring compatibility with the latest financial data standards.
- Increased unit test coverage using Julia's built-in testing framework, improving reliability, error detection, and maintainability for large-scale financial datasets.
- Strengthened error handling and logging by implementing robust exception management and optimized logging mechanisms, improving debugging efficiency for processing billions of trading messages.

ECONET WIRELESS ZIMBABWE

Quality Assurance Engineer (Intern)

Sept 2023 – Nov 2023

- Executed manual and functional testing for SaaS-based applications, designing test cases and scripts that improved product reliability by 10% and reduced production bugs by 15%.
- Expanded unit test coverage by 23.6%, identifying untested code, improving reliability, and automating test execution for robust financial data processing.
- Implemented automated logging and CI/CD testing, reducing debugging time by 20% and improving the development workflow for future contributors

PROJECTS

SHONA GRAMMAR AND SPELL CHECKER DEVELOPMENT

June 2024 - Present

- Engineered a custom grammar and spell checker for the Shona language, leveraging insights from 20+ linguistic resources to enhance accuracy and usability.
- Partnered with leading professors, morphologists, and machine learning researchers, improving linguistic pattern recognition and processing efficiency.
- Collected, cleaned, and analyzed 6 large Shona datasets, applying advanced NLP techniques to boost precision and error detection.

CREATING A MULTILINGUAL SIGN LANGUAGE DATASET: BRIDGING GHANAIAN AND AMERICAN SIGN LANGUAGE FOR TRANSLATION AND GENERATION

July 2024 - Present

- Curating and annotating a multilingual sign language dataset, aligning English sentences with Ghanaian Sign Language (GSL) and American Sign Language (ASL) videos to support translation and generation tasks.
- Developing data preprocessing techniques and model training strategies to improve recognition accuracy and generalization, enabling models to interpret continuous, context-dependent sign language communication effectively.
- Advancing accessibility in African sign language technologies by building a high-quality signed-sentence dataset, contributing to real-time Sign Language Translation (SLT) systems for improved communication between Deaf and Hard of

Hearing (DHH) communities and non-signers.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Java, C/C++, SQL

Machine Learning & AI: NLP, Deep Learning, LangChain, GPT-4, Transformers, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, Computer Vision, Hugging Face, OpenCV, Model Optimization, Explainable AI (XAI), LLM Fine-tuning

Software Development: GitHub, GitLab, Agile Methodologies, CI/CD, Unit Testing

Frontend & Mobile Development: Flutter, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React, Figma (Wireframing & Prototyping), API Integration, RESTful Services

Embedded & Hardware Development: VHDL, FPGA Programming

Data & Analytics: Google Analytics, Pandas, NumPy, Data Visualization (Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly), Google Analytics, SQL Query Optimization

Development Tools: Visual Studio Code, Jupyter Notebook, Linux, Bash Scripting, Docker, Kubernetes, Google Cloud, Serverless Architectures

Project Management Tools: ClickUp, Agile Methodologies, Slack

Databases & CRMs: Salesforce, SQL Query Optimization

Languages: Fluent in English and Shona

Certifications & Training: Introduction to TensorFlow for Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, and Deep Learning(Coursera), Introduction to Software Engineering(Coursera)